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Due Jul 20 11:59pm Available from Jul 14 until Jul 21 3 points possible

3 Replies, 3 Unread

Film History

Discussion

Be Natural: The Untold Story of Alice Guy-Blaché **(Pamela B. Green, 2018)**

Initial post is DUE by [Sunday 7/20 at 11:59pm]. Reply post(s) DUE by [Sunday 7/20 at 11:59pm].

Purpose

Our discussion for this Module focuses on the neglected history of Alice Guy-Blaché. How does one of the most important pioneers of cinema go unnoticed for nearly 100 years? We will examine questions of film historiography and explore the work of Alice Guy-Blaché.

Instructions

For your **Initial Discussion Post** due by Sunday 7/20 at 11:59pm, please respond to the following prompt below in a post of at least 300 words. You do not have to address every detail of the prompt, but your post should contribute to the discussion and not merely repeat what has already been posted by your classmates. While I encourage you to offer your personal views of the films in this Module, **please refrain from unproductive summaries of story or plot and/or why a film is "good" or "bad."** Assume that everyone in the discussion group has completed the viewing assignment and understands the story/plot of the film. I suggest that you draft your post in Word first and assume that something may go wrong in Canvas when you hit 'Post Reply.' I will not count summary of plot/story or information that is not relevant to the prompt/analysis of one scene toward the required 300-word count. **Please identify the time 0(hr):00(min):00(sec) in the film** where the scene you are analyzing begins and concludes from the stream of the film included in the Module. Please do not repost the questions from this prompt into your post.

Your analysis should refer to course materials and reflect on how film style and history function. A post that earns full points will not merely agree with course materials, but will visually illustrate ideas through personal observation. **Do not forget to include embedded media that visualizes the example(s) in your post.** Please make sure that you read all of the posts in your discussion group before posting. I cannot give full points to posts that analyze scenes or shots that have already been selected by another classmate. Please limit your posts to no more than 400 words and 1-2 examples to give others a chance to write about key scenes/shots. **Please resize your screenshots and images to 'Extra Large' in the 'Image Options.'** The 'Image Options' tag appears above or below an image when you click on it while editing in the Rich Content Editor.

Grading Rubric Checklist for Full Points (Initial Post):

- Post identifies the time where the scene you are analyzing begins and concludes from the stream of the film included in the Module.
- **Post analyzes no less than one minute and no more than three minutes of one scene.** If you wish to discuss another scene, please do so in your response to another classmate.
- Post addresses materials related to the prompt and course materials.
- Post includes at least two embedded screen captures from the scene you are analyzing. **Please resize your screenshots and images to 'Extra Large' in the 'Image Options.'** The 'Image Options' tag appears above or below an image when you click on it while editing in the Rich Content Editor.
- Post does not analyze a scene previously selected by a classmate earlier in the thread. Sometimes a classmate will post about the scene you are analyzing while you are writing. It happens. Just message me and let me know.
- Post includes a YouTube clip from an Alice Guy-Blaché film.

Please Resize Your Screen Captures to 'Extra Large'

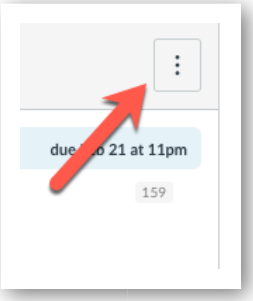
For your **Response Post** to one classmate due by Sunday 7/20 at 11:59pm, please reply in 75 words or more to at least one classmate's post. Responses

may include describing your own insight related to the post, providing additional information from assigned or outside content, disagreeing respectfully by describing your own interpretation, proposing a new idea, or asking a question. I cannot give full points to posts that merely "like" or agree with another post; the response post must demonstrate substantial effort. Please try to respond to a classmate who has not yet received a response.

- Please choose one scene from *Be Natural: The Untold Story of Alice Guy-Blaché* and **embed at least two (2) screenshots** from the scene into your post. Please describe which of the four historical approaches outlined in the reading that your example demonstrates: aesthetic, technological, economic, or social history (cultural). How does the documentary's approach to history in your example allow us to understand Alice Guy-Blaché, the origin of cinema, female influence in film history, film style, and/or culture in unique ways?
- In addition, please choose one Alice Guy-Blaché film on YouTube and embed the film into your post. The documentary *Be Natural: The Untold Story of Alice Guy-Blaché* provides dozens of films that you can investigate. How can we analyze the films and/or their form/content via aesthetic history, technological history, economic history, and cultural history? Are there any formal characteristics in your film example that you wish to bring attention to: (cinematography, editing, sound, acting, mise-en-scène)? What innovations can you see in the films of Guy-Blaché?

Discussion Rubric

To view the grading rubric for this discussion, click on the "more options" icon (3 vertical dots at the top) and then select "show rubric".



Mobile App users: Click Grades, then click into the Discussion. The rubric can then be found on the Grades tab.

Aim for excellence! These are the criteria for what comprises an "Excellent" rating for a discussion post:

- Addresses each part of the discussion prompt(s).
- Postings demonstrate reflective and critical thinking, not just recitation of information from textbook.